20 Practical Ways to Use AI Beyond Writing Emails

20 practical applications for ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, and other AI assistants.

By Weiwei Hu LinkedIn GitHub

Get Things Done at Work | Plan, prepare, and follow through

01
Break a complicated project into manageable tasks
Project plan
- Deliverables and tasks
- Dependencies and owners
- Milestone timeline

02
Extract important information from long documents
Document brief
- Key findings and numbers
- Decisions and actions
- Source references

03
Prepare for an important meeting
Meeting prep
- Opening and key points
- Tough questions
- Evidence gaps

04
Practice a difficult conversation
Role-play
- Natural opening
- Realistic pushback
- Feedback on tone

05
Organize scattered notes into useful actions
Notes to actions
- Actions and waiting-on
- Owners and deadlines
- Top three to start

Take Control of Your Time | Protect hours for the work that matters

06
Plan your week around your priorities
Weekly plan
- Protected focus time
- Grouped activities
- What to postpone

07
Decide what to do first
Prioritize
- Ranked task table
- Today's top three
- Delegate or drop

08
Reorganize your day when plans fall apart
Re-plan the day
- What still fits
- What moves
- Deadlines to renegotiate

09
Manage recurring responsibilities
Recurring checklist
- Prep and materials
- Completion criteria
- Automate vs. review

Make Better Decisions | Test your choices before you commit

10
Compare several options side by side
Side-by-side
- Benefits, costs, risks
- Short- and long-term
- Facts vs. assumptions

11
Find risks you may have overlooked
Risk review
- Five ways it could fail
- Early warning signs
- Skeptic's questions

12
Explore what-if scenarios
Scenarios
- Conservative to optimistic
- Assumptions that matter most
- Calculations shown

Make Everyday Life Easier | Money, meals, travel, home, and people

13
Understand where your money goes
Spending review
- Spend by category
- Recurring payments
- Ways to save

14
Plan meals using what you already have
Meal plan
- Five weekday dinners
- Uses what you have
- One shopping list

15
Plan a trip around your interests and budget
Trip itinerary
- Day-by-day plan
- Costs and transport
- What to verify

16
Organize home maintenance and responsibilities
Home upkeep
- Monthly to annual tasks
- DIY vs. professional
- Reminders

17
Prepare for a sensitive personal conversation
Personal talk
- Warm opening
- Blame-free framing
- Questions to ask

Make Progress on Your Personal Goals | Learn, plan, and review your progress

18
Learn a new skill with a structured practice plan
Learning plan
- Weekly objectives
- Daily exercises
- Tutor-style feedback

19
Turn a personal goal into a realistic action plan
Goal plan
- Milestones and timeline
- First seven days
- Busy-week version

20
Review your progress and decide what to do next
Weekly review
- Planned vs. done
- Recurring obstacles
- Next week's top three

Work Time Decisions Everyday life Personal goals

Save this page and come back whenever a task needs a better starting point.

Start with one thing you already need to do

You don't need to try all twenty. Pick something already on your to-do list: a meeting tomorrow, a decision you keep revisiting, or a goal you've been postponing. Tell your AI assistant your situation, explain what you're trying to accomplish, and ask for the outputs on the matching card. Then review the result, correct what needs correcting, and put it into practice.

The most useful AI prompt is often the one that helps you finish something you've already been meaning to do.

A small challenge for this week

1. Choose one application that matches a task already on your list.
2. Describe your situation to your AI assistant and ask for the outputs listed on the card.
3. Evaluate the result. Did it save time, improve your preparation, surface another option, or make the next action easier?

If the result felt generic, add more context or name the exact output you need. For anything that affects your health, finances, or business, verify the facts before you act.

Full copy-ready prompts for all 20: github.com/wei-wei-hu/everyday-ai-playbook